



PROOF AND EVIDENCE

One of the most powerful elements of persuasion and influence

Proof!

Demonstration (Single most powerful proof element)

Renolds wrap: Flame to Tinfoil and then grabbing...

Vacuum cleaner - look at all crap got after yours just did it.

Window in Dyson

Invisible shield - plexiglass - Football heading towards family

Zero water - red wine- clear water

Blend it - iPhones - bricks, etc in Blendtec blender...

Lifelock... my social security number is..... 5839-20-2092

Ex: Clasp hands together - (instantly verifiable - Don hobbs)

Reasons why... (Lord & Thomas secret weapon - built most profitable agency)

Give reasons why what you're saying is TRUE.

Examples:

Why is your financial editor more successful than others?

Why does this supplement work

Why are you able to clean carpets twice as fast, for half as much?

Why should I believe this?

Illustrations:

“Half off sale! vs. Fire Sale - everything Half Off”

“Slice - a better tasting soft drink because it contains 10-percent real fruit juice”

“Kleenex towels absorb 50 percent more because they're two layers thick”

Specificity...

Highly specific writing is nearly always preferable to vague or general writing.

Precise numbers

Exact names, positions, or titles of people

Specific institutions, divisions, or companies

Precise publications, TV shows, or forms of media

Target specific group of people, location, or problem (For Mothers Only... L.A.s favorite beer... Corns?)

Logical Argument...Begin with Agreement

Make sure that a strong, logical argument runs throughout your copy.

Start with something your prospect can agree with or easily/self verify – then move to points b – c – and ultimate conclusion –buying your product is a no brainer

Strong Examples...

With every example ask – “is this the best example of the point I’m trying to make? What would make it stronger? Keep pushing until just about anyone would be willing to believe your claim.

Problems Motivate -- Torn pants example...

Guarantees...

1. Personal guarantee: Have guarantee written in voice of the writer/spokesman
2. Use signature
3. Make Iron Clad, bomb proof - crazy (10 year warranty - Double money back - etc.)
4. Support with visual evidence/certificates, seals, etc

Strong Testimonials...

Be specific

Be Clear

Include headlines

Include variety of perspectives/problems/benefits

Legitimize them – attaché name, city, state/province, phone number, landmarks

Give them a face

Spread them out

Ad audio/video

Before and After...

Make it visually dramatic – strong, immediate contrast

Track Record...

Trackable results your product or service has achieved over a specified period of time

Show you've been a LEADER... consistently one step ahead of market and competitors

You're consistent... add in the time factor... 20 years beats 2 years

Case History/Studies...

Tell the story of amazing changes a user went through

Go beyond repetition... tell a riveting story

Make it emotional –

Make your product the hero

Follow Problem-Solution-Result format

Unique Mechanism...

The unique method, technology, system, process, or approach that allows your product/service to deliver the benefits in ways others can't

The V.I.P.E.R self defense system
The I–T.A.P formula for outwitting your most formidable competitors
New Cause = New Mechanism
Professional services sell branded processes

Vivid Pictures... (Picture worth 1000 words)

Paint vivid, detailed pictures and make the experience feel more real

The more realistic and tangible the better...

Rich detail and imagery

Scientific language...

Perhaps sprinkle in a technical, scientific-sounding explanation

Occasionally use a word the prospect doesn't understand

Be careful not to over-do this and bury the reader beneath a pile of meaningless buzzwords and generalities.

Process Sidebars/Illustrations...

Illustrate exactly how something works through visual imagery....

Plaque-filled artery, suddenly exposed to a miracle nutrient, magically becomes clean... Water filter trapping deadly bacteria and toxins... images of infrared rays shooting from the heater penetrating every object in the house.

Clinical Studies...

Four Keys:

1. Effectiveness... tell how effectively it performed in the study
2. Source; reveal the institution that conducted the study

3. Publication: reveal where the study results were published
4. Date: for specificity....include exact month, day and year of the study you're citing

Media Appearances...

TV implies expertise and accomplishment.... Mention any aspect of your offer/product that has been mentioned on a reputable TV show or channel

Expert Endorsements...

Find credible third-party experts in market – see if they've written books, websites, or anything else that might possibly mention an ingredient in your product or a claim you're making

Charts & Graphs...

Pie chart or bar graph far more convincing than numbers in a spread sheet

Prestigious Publications...

Include statements that support your points from major publications... small sources weaken argument...

Include dates, include a small photo of the article or publication

Celebrity Endorsements/Fortune 100 clients...

Include photos, logos, pictures of headquarters, etc.

Mitchell - Irvine Company example -

Credible Certifications...

Harvard Medical
Wharton Finance MBA

Certification organizations
Etc

Awards...

Life blood of modern ad agency

Sell against...

Get rich slowly...

The case against mobile marketing

Social Media: Why it may not be right for you?

If the company or speaker/writer is known for being a proponent of solution - it gains even more credibility

Quotes...

Confusions, Solomon, Sun Tze, Abraham Lincoln

Facts...

Davinci Code intro -

Statistics...

“Four out of 5 doctors recommend tylenol for headaches”

Analogies...

“That’s like \$7000 a year raise!”

Metaphor

“Pour your car a new engine”

Democratic Reviews

Amazon reviews

Trip Advisor

Expedia

Product proofs toolbox

Sample proofs that can be used for products

Construction evidence... facts about materials, manufacture, specifications of quality concerning ingredients, design, workmanship of product itself

Reputation and Standing as a firm

- how long in business
- size-resources of plant
- laboratory
- finance
- inanimate facilities
- company policies showing...
- integrity
- experience
- reputation
- geographic or climatic advantages
- location

Management Personnel

Abilities/authoritative experience of founder or any executives

Production or service personnel

- long-experienced craftsmen
- engineers
- research people
- designers
- workers
- installation professionals

Quality of Materials or design

- Laboratory test facts
- specifications
- strength
- streamline design
- durability
- beauty
- washability
- utility
- color fastness
- purity
- any product merit
- value of one single ingredient - give it trade name
- names of suppliers if known

Patents or machinery

- Special processes
- special/unique machinery

Speed of delivery

- proving freshness
- 30 minutes or less
- make money tomorrow

Design or material of container

- proving speed
- hardiness
- convenience
- cleanliness
- extra utility
- reusability
- environmental friendly

Performance evidence... achievement of product in actual use...

- Achievements of product
- endurance runs

milage records
laundry test
dramatic performance records
 ordinary use
 extremely difficult conditions
before and after photographs
discriminating or well known users
 exceptional usefulness and necessity
 sole inserts for policeman
 watches for railroad-men
 sun tan lotion for lifeguards

Product authorities themselves buy
 medicine doctors take
 tooth brush used by dentist
 Makeup by movie star beautician

Increasing popularity

Test evidence

General Principles

*** Involvement - let them do it. ... Free trials/samples/demo versions of software, hands on demonstrations, “Monkey see - monkey do”

*** Instantly verifiable (Don Hobbs - Clasp Hands - Grab tinfoil - vacuum

*** Understatement -- easy on adjectives...

“The greatest hotel in America” vs. “One of America’s truly great hotels”

"Men Wanted for Hazardous Journey, Small Wages, Bitter Cold, Long Months of Complete Darkness, Constant Danger, Safe Return Doubtful, Honor and Recognition in Case of Success."

*** Acknowledge disbelief